

Common Application | Undergraduate

Rowan Foster | CAID: APP_015 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_015
First Name	Rowan
Last Name	Foster
Date Of Birth	2/12/08
Mailing Address	1014 Test Court, Austin, TX 78701
Primary Phone Number	512-555-0114
Email Address	rowan.foster.015@example.com
Gender	Male
Ethnicity	White
Country	USA
Region	Southwest

Education and application details

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Name of HS	Austin High School
Counselor Name	Alex Singh
Intended Major	Undecided
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	4
Weighted GPA	4.48
Rank	32/397
Superscored SAT Score	Not provided
Superscored ACT Score	34

AP Courses

AP Physics C Electricity and Magnetism, AP Calculus AB, AP Environmental Science, AP Computer Science Principles, AP English Language, AP Biology, AP Chemistry, AP Physics 2

Total APs

8

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Concert band musician, Robotics club member, School newspaper editor, Science club member, Youth orchestra musician

Awards

Not provided

Hooks

None really, gonna do marching band

Personal essay

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Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

Between the rehearsal and the repair

A difficult passage in concert band reminded me of a problem in robotics club: trying harder was not helping because I was repeating the same mistake. I slowed the passage down and practiced the transition. Later, I brought that same patience to a design that needed revision.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in an undecided course of study comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to give uncertainty enough time to become useful. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.